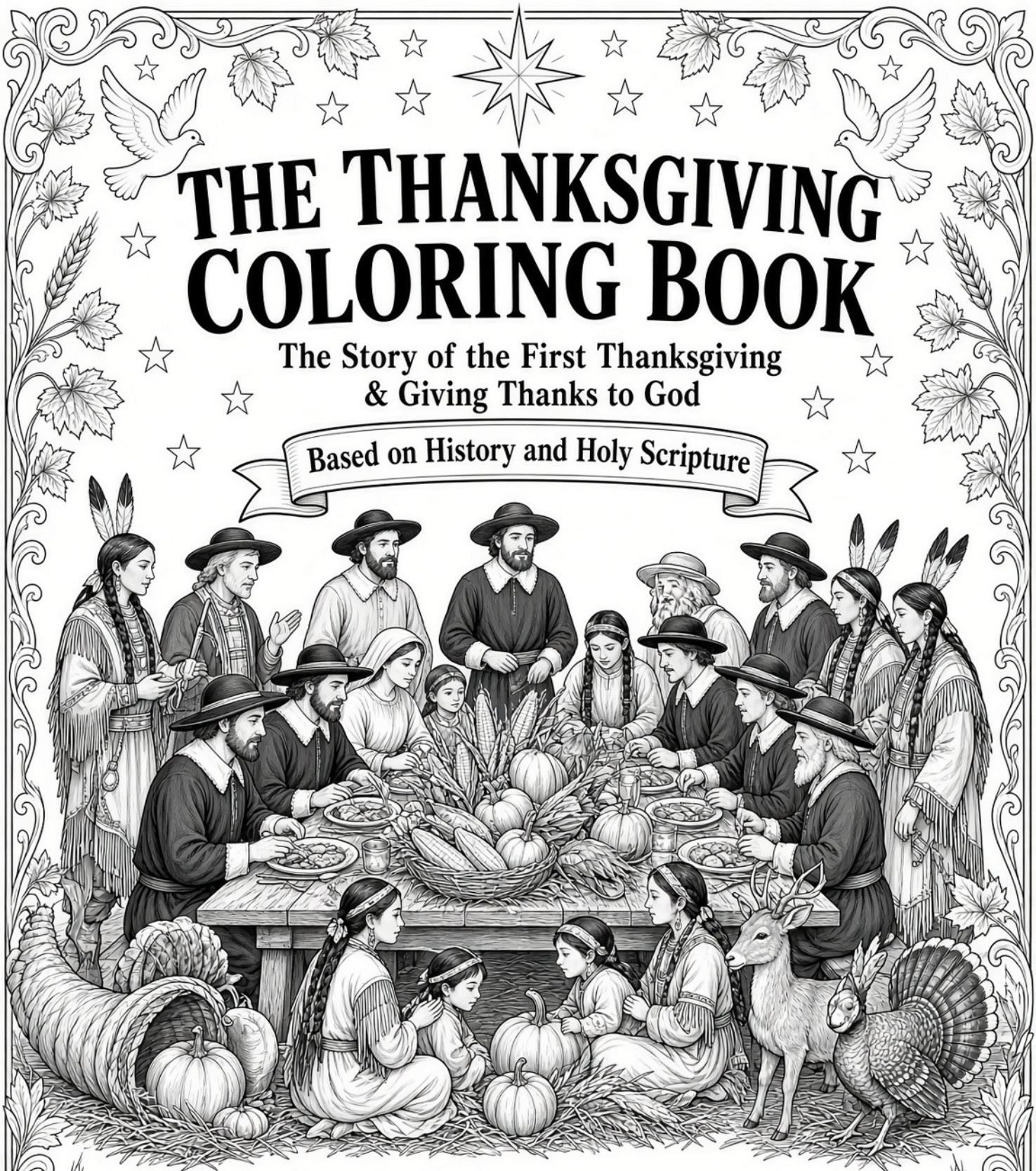


THE THANKSGIVING COLORING BOOK

The Story of the First Thanksgiving
& Giving Thanks to God

Based on History and Holy Scripture



From the Mayflower voyage to the
1621 harvest feast with the Wampanoag,
and the biblical call to give thanks in all things.

Give thanks to the Lord, for he is good;
his love endures forever.

(Psalm 107:1)

THE MAYFLOWER VOYAGE

1620 - Seeking Religious Freedom



In 1620, a group of English Separatists (the Pilgrims) sailed on the Mayflower seeking freedom to worship God. After a difficult 66-day voyage, they landed at Plymouth Rock.

‘The Lord is my strength and my shield;
my heart trusts in him, and he helps me.’
(Psalm 28:7)

The Pilgrims trusted God through storms and hardship to start a new life in America.

Hebrew: 'todah' = thanksgiving / praise.
Greek: 'eucharistia' = thanksgiving
(from eu=good + charis=grace).

THE FIRST HARD WINTER

Plymouth 1620-1621



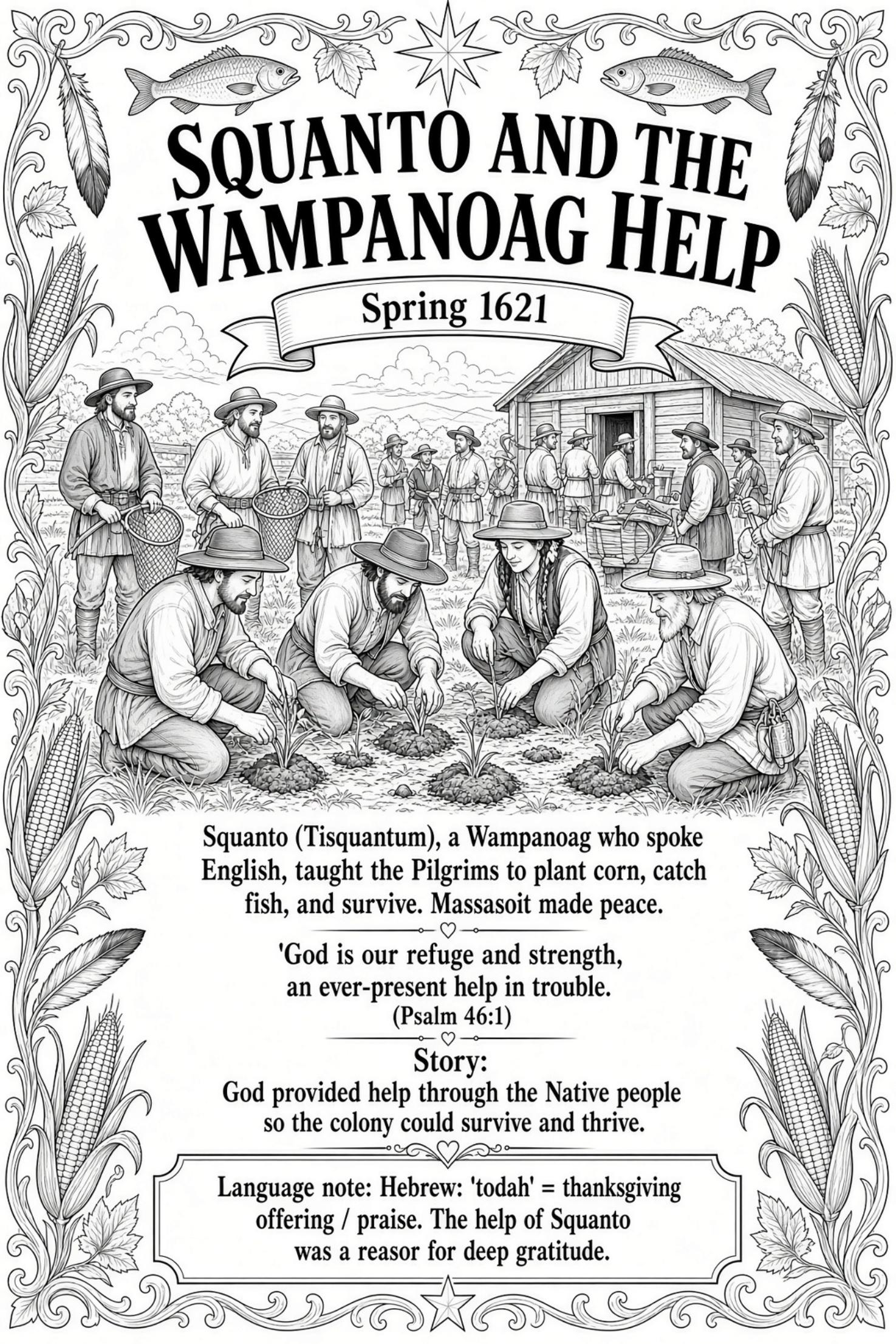
Nearly half of the Mayflower passengers died during the first bitter winter from disease and cold. Yet the survivors trusted God and persevered.

‘Weeping may stay for the night, but rejoicing comes in the morning.

(Psalm 30:5)

Through great hardship, the Pilgrims clung to faith and hope in God's provision.

Greek: ‘eucharisteo’ = to give thanks.
Even in suffering we are called to thanksgiving.



SQUANTO AND THE WAMPANOAG HELP

Spring 1621



Squanto (Tisquantum), a Wampanoag who spoke English, taught the Pilgrims to plant corn, catch fish, and survive. Massasoit made peace.

'God is our refuge and strength,
an ever-present help in trouble.
(Psalm 46:1)

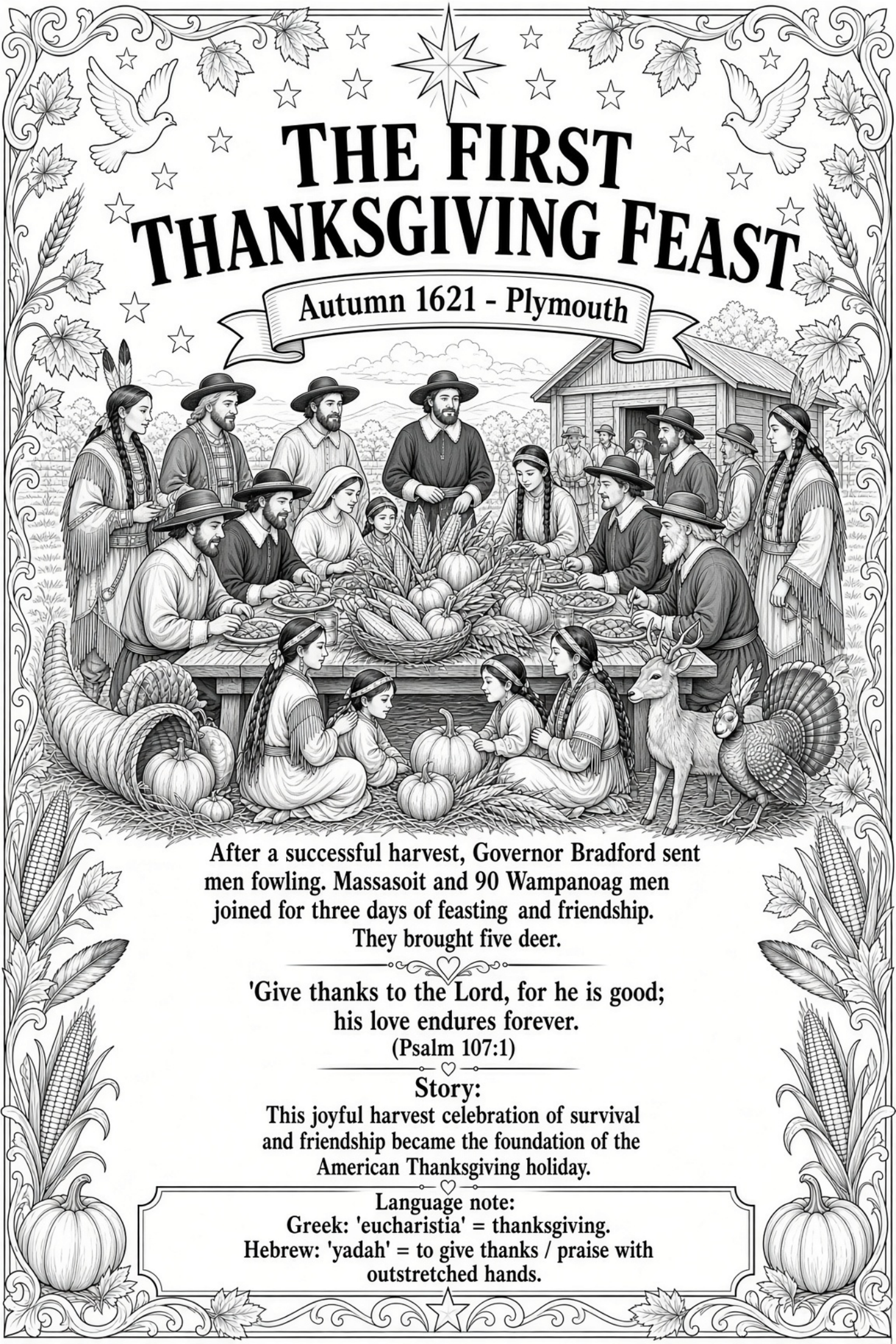
Story:

God provided help through the Native people
so the colony could survive and thrive.

Language note: Hebrew: 'todah' = thanksgiving
offering / praise. The help of Squanto
was a reason for deep gratitude.

THE FIRST THANKSGIVING FEAST

Autumn 1621 - Plymouth



After a successful harvest, Governor Bradford sent men fowling. Massasoit and 90 Wampanoag men joined for three days of feasting and friendship.

They brought five deer.

'Give thanks to the Lord, for he is good;
his love endures forever.

(Psalm 107:1)

Story:

This joyful harvest celebration of survival and friendship became the foundation of the American Thanksgiving holiday.

Language note:

Greek: 'eucharistia' = thanksgiving.

Hebrew: 'yadah' = to give thanks / praise with outstretched hands.

GIVE THANKS IN ALL THINGS

1 Thessalonians 5:16-18

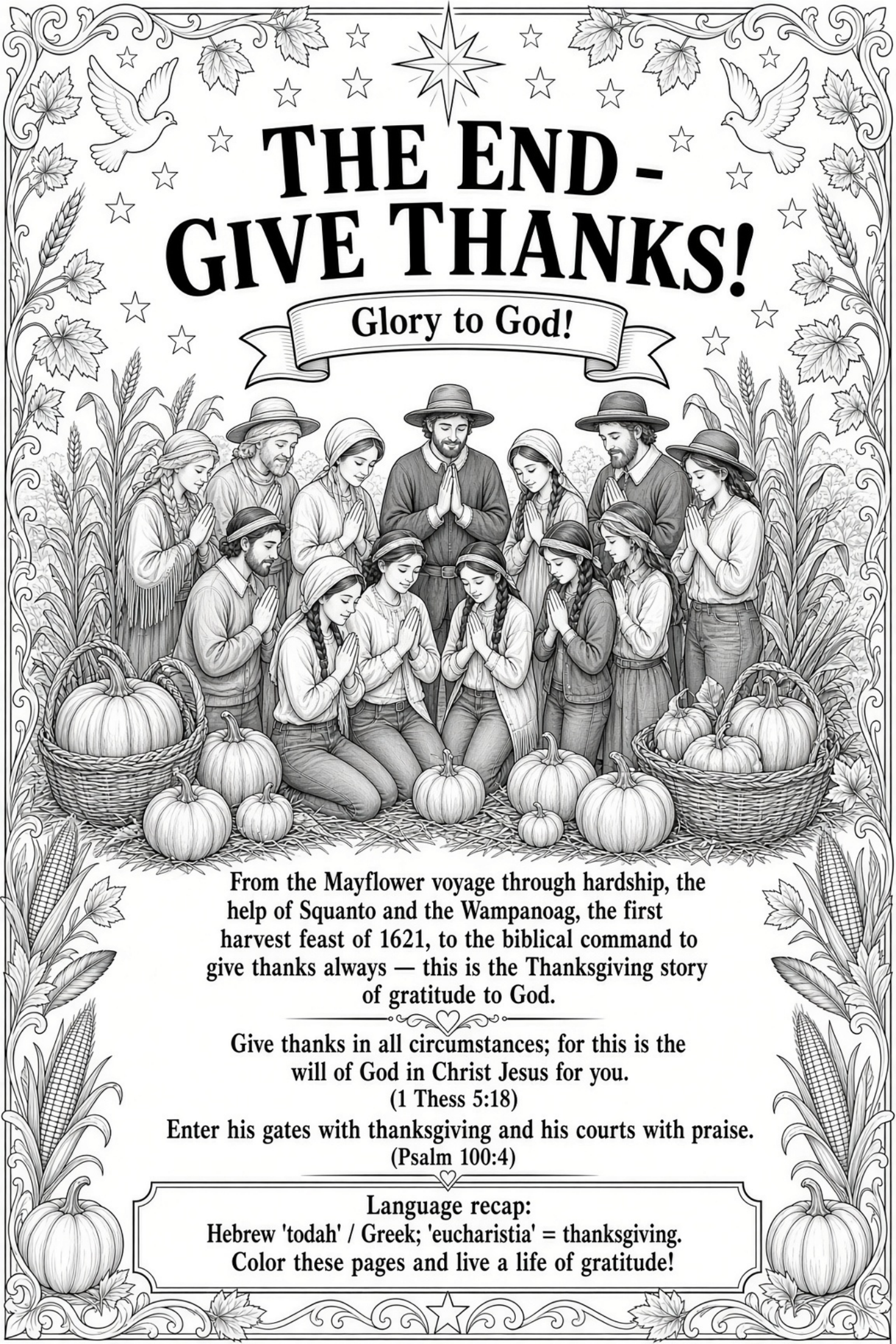


Rejoice always, pray without ceasing,
give thanks in all circumstances;
for this is the will of God in Christ Jesus for you.

Whether in hardship or abundance, the Bible calls
us to a life of continual thanksgiving to God.

Greek: 'eucharisteite' = give thanks (imperative).
'pantote' = always.
Thanksgiving is God's will for us.

Let everything that has breath praise the Lord!
(Psalm 150:6)



THE END - GIVE THANKS!

Glory to God!

From the Mayflower voyage through hardship, the help of Squanto and the Wampanoag, the first harvest feast of 1621, to the biblical command to give thanks always — this is the Thanksgiving story of gratitude to God.

Give thanks in all circumstances; for this is the will of God in Christ Jesus for you.

(1 Thess 5:18)

Enter his gates with thanksgiving and his courts with praise.

(Psalm 100:4)

Language recap:

Hebrew 'todah' / Greek; 'eucharistia' = thanksgiving.

Color these pages and live a life of gratitude!